Alcohol (ages 36, 43, 53 and 60+ years)

Contents

Document details

Output variables	avalc82, avalc89, avalc99, avalc09, avalc82u, avalc89u, avalc99u, avalc09u, av82wnr, av82wnw, av82bci, av82wnf, av82spi, av82wnru, av82wnwu, av82bciu, av82wnfu, av82spiu, dralc09, drspt89, drwin89, drbee89, dralc99, drsp99, drspt99, drwn99, drwin99, drbe99, drbee99, dra09, drs09, ndrs09, drw09, ndrw09, drb09, ndrb09, atdr09, bdr09, cudr09, fdr09

Alcohol- Diet diaries (36, 43, 53, 60+ years)

Alcohol consumption was assessed using a food diary in which participants were asked to record information on the amount of alcohol consumed over 5 consecutive days. These intakes were summarised and coded in grams per day, using a specially designed data-entry program and analysed using in-house nutrient analysis program at MRC Human Nutrition Research. In 1982 and 1989, the diet diaries were complimented by an extra 2 days recall interview conducted by a research nurse (McNaughton, Mishra, Stephen, & Wadsworth, 2007).

Method

Diet diaries 7-day recall for alcohol consumption in 1982,1989, 1999, 2009

- 2-day recall -done by research nurse interviews
- 5-days diaries –completed by study members

Summary of variables in: Two databases (one short & one detailed with all alcohol variables)

The short version contains the variables for the average daily alcohol at age 36, 43, 53 and 60+ from the diet diaries. **FILE: ..\alc_82-09_short.sav'**

avalc82	average alcohol/day grams82
avalc89	average alcohol/day grams89
avalc99	average alcohol/day grams99
avalc09	average alcohol/day grams09
avalc82u	average alcohol/day units82
avalc89u	average alcohol/day units89
avalc99u	average alcohol/day units99
avalc09u	average alcohol/day units09

The detailed version contains all alcohol variables for the average daily alcohol at age 36, 43, 53 and 60+ from the diet diaries and those from questionnaires (including CAGE questions) at age 43, 53 and 60+ questions about alcohol consumption as:

- wnr= Weight of red wine consumption
- wnw=Weight of white wine consumption
- bci=Weight of beer and cider consumption
- wnf Weight of wine, sherry, vermouth consumption
- spi=Weight of spirits consumption

av82wnr	av grams/day red wine 82
av82wnw	av grams/day wine wine 82
av82bci	av grams/day beer 82
av82wnf	av grams/day sherry 82
av82spi	av grams/day spirits 82
av82wnru	av **unit**/day red wine 82

av82wnwu	av unit/day wine wine 82
av82bciu	av unit/day beer 82
av82wnfu	av unit/day sherry 82
av82spiu	av unit/day spirits 82

Similar for each year

- Thus the quantities reported were approximately equivalent to units of alcohol. The total number of drinks was used as the measure of consumption of alcohol (U) in the past week, and this total was multiplied by 8 to give alcohol consumption in grams (Royal College of Physicians, 1996).
- Moderation means a maximum of 3-4 units a day for men and 2-3 units for women (with one unit representing half a pint of average-strength beer, one small glass of wine or a standard pub measure of spirits or fortified wine such as sherry).

Alcohol –Self completion questionnaires (43 and 53 years)

- Self-completion questionnaire in 1989, 1999, 2009 (not in 1982)

The amount of alcohol consumed over a period of consecutive 7 days was also obtained (Richards et al., 2005). Study members were asked about the amount of alcoholic drinks consumed during this interval, within the categories of beers, wines, and spirits. Answers were given in terms of units: half pints of beer, glasses of wine and measures of spirits.

- Consumption of alcohol was based on responses to the question ‘in the last 7 days how many of the following drinks have you had?
- Three categories of drink were differentiated: spirits (measures of spirits or liqueurs), wine (glasses of wine, sherry, Martini or port), and beer (half pints of beer, larger, cider or stout).

dralc09	Have you drunk alcohol in the last year?
drsp09	In the last 7 days have you had any spirits or liqueurs?
drs09	In the last 7 days have you had any spirits or liqueurs?
ndrs09	How many measures of spirits or liqueurs have you had in the last 7 days?
drw09	In the last 7 days have you had any wine, sherry, martini or port?
ndrw09	How many measures of wine, sherry, martini or port have you had in the last 7 days
drb09	In the last 7 days have you had any beer, lager, cider, or stout?
ndrb09	How many half pints of beer, lager, cider, or stout have you had in the last 7 days

CAGE questions (self-completed at 43, 53 and 60+ years)

The CAGE questions were asked of lifetime experience and where the answer to a question was ‘yes’, study members were asked whether they had experienced this ‘in the last year’. The CAGE score is defined as the number of affirmative answers to these questions, ranging from 0 to 4. Subjects with CAGE scores of 2, 3 or 4 are referred to have drinking problems. CAGE questions assess risk of alcohol abuse with more than 70% sensitivity and 80% specificity (Ewing, 1984; Bush et al., 1987; Buchsbaum et al., 1991) using the 4 following statements:

1. Have you ever felt you ought to **C**ut down your drinking?
2. Have people ever **A**nnoyed you by criticising your drinking?
3. Have you ever felt bad or **G**uilty about your drinking?
4. Have you ever had to have a drink first thing in the morning to steady your nerves or get rid of hangover (**E**ye opener)?

The score was dichotomised to “2 or more” (indicating potential alcohol abuse) vs. “less than 2” ‘yes’ answers (see also Ely et al., 1999).

cudr09	In the last year have you felt you ought to cut down on your drinking?
atdr09	In the last year have people ever annoyed you by criticising your drinking?
bdr09	In the last year have you ever felt bad or guilty about your drinking?
fdr09	In the last year, have you ever had a drink first thing in the morning to steady your nerves?

***Note there are variations in the name of variables from 1999 to 2009.

More information

The research nurse reviewed the method and details required for recording all food and drinks consumed in the previous two days with the survey member, who was then asked to keep the diary for the subsequent five days and to return it by pre-paid post. Thus the first two days of the diet diary were recorded retrospectively by the nurse, who prompted the study member for information; the subsequent five days were completed by the respondents themselves. A copy of the first two days was retained by the nurse. The diary comprised daily sheets, each identified by date and the day of the week, which providing spaces to record meals, including alcoholic and non-alcoholic drinks and between meal-snacks, with an extra section to record any other snack or drink not recorded previously. This section included specific prompts for beer, wine, sherry or spirits besides such items as sweets, tea, or other common food items which may have been taken between meals. The layout of the sheets was structured in three columns headed: “food/drink”; “description and preparation” and “amount”.

These intakes were summarised and coded in grams per day, using a specially designed data-entry program and analysed using an in-house nutrient analysis program at MRC Human Nutrition Research. The alcoholic content of the drinks was converted to grams of alcohol per 100 ml. This conversion was based on a study of the average alcohol content of 29 beers, ciders, wines, liqueurs and spirits derived from samples of each type {Paul, 1978 468 /id}. Total alcohol consumed per day (in grams) was calculated from the quantities and types of drinks reported. Data consisted of 7 days entries, correspondent to the alcohol consumption on each day of the diary.

Where appropriate for these analyses, grams of alcohol were converted to units (U) (all variables ith u at the end) based on of alcohol, dividing by 8g/units according to the UK government guidelines of 8g of pure alcohol per unit. The amount of ethanol contained in a particular type of alcoholic drink was calculated by multiplying the volume of the alcoholic beverage and the percentage of ethanol contained in the drink, which was then converted into units of ethanol, using the formula: one unit = amount of alcohol in ml/ gram multiplied by the % alcohol by volume (ABV) and then divided by 1000. Percent ABV was considered as 12% for wine, 3.5 for beer, 17.5% for sherry, and 40% for spirits.

Further classifications of alcohol data were conducted according to the Department of Health (DOH) guidelines. Based on DOH criteria, separate categories of alcohol consumption were created for men and women as follows: 0 drinks/day (abstainers), 0-2units/day (light drinkers), 2-4 units/day (moderate drinkers), 4-8 units /day (heavy drinkers) and more than >8 units/day (very heavy drinkers) for men; and 0 drinks/day (abstainers), 0-1.5 units/day (light drinkers), 1.5-3 units/day (moderate drinkers), 3-6 units /day (heavy drinkers) and more than >6 units/day (very heavy drinkers) for women. Heavy and very heavy drinking categories were merged for females because few women fell into the very heavy drinking category.

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References

1 Alcohol unit calculations were based on U. K. Government guidelines, http://www. direct. gov. uk/en/HealthandWellbeing/DG_10036434

2 Department of Health, http://www.dh.gov.uk/prod_consum_dh/groups/dh_digitalassets/@dh/@en/documents/digitalasset/dh_075219.pdf

Literature Review

Findings from the 1946 Cohort

From the Medical Research Council National Survey of Health and Development (the 1946 British Cohort) with subjects followed from 1982 to 1989 and 1999 when study members were 36, 43 and respectively 53 years old.

Alcohol consumption was associated with slower memory decline from 43 to 53 years in men, but a more rapid decline in visual search speed over the same interval in women. The study used information on alcohol consumption over the previous 7 days from the self-completed questionnaires at age 43 and studied decline in memory and speed in concentration. These effects were not explained by childhood cognition, education, adult SES, physical health status, smoking or physical activity. Men consuming light to moderate levels of alcohol had higher SES than abstainers or heavy drinkers; whereas SES and level of alcohol intake showed a more linear (positive) trend (Richards, 2005).

Higher levels of cognitive ability in childhood have shown an increased risk of alcohol abuse in adulthood for both men and women in NSHD, despite the protective effect of cognitive ability on affect. This was shown by Hatch and colleagues in a series of analyses which have included two mental health outcomes at age 53 years: the 28 item General Health Questionnaire (GHQ-28) as a measure of internalising symptoms of anxiety and depression, and the CAGE screen for potential alcohol abuse as an externalising disorder (Hatch, 2007).

In 1989, results from this cohort done by Ely et al, (1999) showed that out of the 3262 study members interviewed, over 97% (3169) answered the CAGE questions and the questions on consumption and was found that the prevalence of drink problems increased with level of alcohol consumption.

It was widely reported that women drink less and have a lower prevalence of drink problems than men, but the gender differences in the relationship between level of drinking and drink problems have rarely been investigated quantitatively.

- It was found that the prevalence of drink problems increased with level of alcohol consumption.
- Women were more likely than men to report drink problems at the same level of alcohol consumption with gender difference largely accounted for by individual differences in weight of body water.
- Beer accounted for the excess of men's drinking over women's and the proportion of alcohol consumed as beer was inversely related to drink problems.
- 80% of women and 52% of men who had drink problems in the past year (1989) reported drinking less than an average of 3 U (women) or 4 U (men) a day in the past week.
- As drinking levels in women begin to approach those in men, rates of drink problems in women are likely to overtake those in men because of women's greater physiological sensitivity to the effects of alcohol.

Variables in this document

29 high-confidence matches

Variable	Label	How it was found
Questionnaire data [55] › Lifestyle [525] › Alcohol [5252]		
atdr09	In the last year have people ever annoyed you by criticising your drinking? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
avalc09	Average alcohol per day in grams - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
avalc09u	Average alcohol per day in units - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
avalc82	Average alcohol per day in grams - at age 36 years	topsheet field
avalc82u	Average alcohol per day in units - at age 36 years	topsheet field

Variable	Label	How it was found
avalc89	Average alcohol per day in grams - at age 43 years	topsheet field
avalc89u	Average alcohol per day in units - at age 43 years	topsheet field
avalc99	Average alcohol per day in grams - at age 53 years	topsheet field
avalc99u	Average alcohol per day in units - at age 53 years	topsheet field
bdr09	In the last year have you ever felt bad or guilty about your drinking? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
cudr09	In the last year have you felt you ought to cut down on your drinking (not including dieting)? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
dra09	Have you drunk alcohol in the last year? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
dralc99	Have you drunk alcohol in the last year? - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drb09	In the last 7 days have you had beer, lager, cider, or stout (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
drbe99	In the last 7 days have you had beer, lager, cider, or stout (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drbee89	How many 1/2 pints of beer, lager, cider, or stout have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 43 years	topsheet field
drbee99	How many 1/2 pints of beer, lager, cider, or stout have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drs09	In the last 7 days have you had spirits or liqueurs e.g. whisky, gin, brandy (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
drsp99	In the last 7 days have you had spirits or liqueurs e.g. whisky, gin, brandy (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drspt89	How many measures of spirits or liqueurs have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 43 years.	topsheet field
drspt99	How many measures of spirits or liqueurs have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drw09	In the last 7 days have you had wine, sherry, martini, or port (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
drwin89	How many glasses of wine, sherry, martini, or port have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 43 years	topsheet field
drwin99	How many glasses of wine, sherry, martini, or port have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 53 years	topsheet field
drwn99	In the last 7 days have you had wine, sherry, martini, or port (alcoholic drinks only) - at age 53 years	topsheet field
fdr09	In the last year, have you ever had a drink first thing in the morning to steady your nerves or to get rid of a hangover? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
ndrb09	How many 1/2 pints of beer, lager, cider, or stout have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field
ndrs09	How many measures of spirits or liqueurs have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 60-64 years.	topsheet field
ndrw09	How many glasses of wine, sherry, martini, or port have you had in the last 7 days? - at age 60-64 years	topsheet field

1 medium-confidence match

Variable	Label	How it was found
Clinical data [51] › Physical measures [110] › Hand examination [1106]		
problems	Any problems identifed with the hands - Hands Examinations 1999	prose scan

2 low-confidence matches

Variable	Label	How it was found
Questionnaire data [55] › Health and medical history [510] › Medical conditions [5101] › Cancer [51012]		
cage	How old were you then (first diagnosis of cancer) - at age 53 years	prose scan
Questionnaire data [55] › Sociodemographics [515] › Economic circumstances [5151]		
ith	Typical hours worked per week, excluding overtime (Coded in hrs first 2 digits and 1/4 hrs third digit e.g. 123 = 12 3/4 hrs) at age 26 years	prose scan